# STRIDE

## Get the athlete paid.
## Show the brand what it bought.

For semi-professional athletes in niche sports, and the local businesses near their club.
Neither side is served today.

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LIVE DEMO
stride-demo.onrender.com

WHY THIS, FROM ME

# I am not researching this market from outside it

### ATHLETE

Capped by the Lebanese national rugby team, with international tournament experience. The athletes in my research are people I play with, which is why the conversations were candid rather than performative.

### OPERATOR

Four years in management consulting across MENA. Feasibility studies at $5 to 15M, DCF modelling, and an OpEx reorganisation that delivered SAR 650M of capital optimisation.

### BUILDER

MSc Business Analytics at ESADE. The deployed product, the analytics engine and the financial model behind this plan are all my own work.

The plan can make claims about the technology that are checkable rather than aspirational, because I wrote it.

WHAT FIVE ATHLETES TOLD ME

# €0

CURRENT INCOME FROM THEIR AUDIENCE

## Not low. Not inconsistent. Nothing

> People are not going to spend time setting up social media and building followers purely around their sport if nothing comes back.

Rugby league players competing in Spain and Lebanon, and top-ranked Lebanese CrossFit athletes. The founder is capped by the Lebanese national rugby team, which is how this access exists.

### THE INEQUITY IS FELT

Influencers producing far less demanding content earn more than competing athletes do

### SPONSORSHIP ARRIVES DESPITE THE SPORT

The one athlete who has a sponsor did not get it as a rugby league player

### SO THEY STOP BUILDING AN AUDIENCE

Which suppresses the very supply the market is measured on

Primary research, five semi-structured interviews, 2026. Convenience sample, reported as one.

THE BUYER'S HALF

# A local brand spends on instinct, and never finds out

## “What did you get back, and how did you know?”

The question the sponsor discovery programme is built around. It is the one the whole analytics engine exists to answer, and today nobody below the professional tier owns an instrument that can.

### WHO THE BUYER IS

Physiotherapy clinics, gyms, car dealers, restaurants and regional insurers within reach of an anchor athlete's club. The segment the agencies will not serve, and the one this model is built on.

### CHOOSE

Two athletes, and nothing to compare them on but follower count, which is the one number that can be bought.

### PRICE

No rate card and no benchmark anywhere in the segment. The fee is whatever was asked for.

### VERIFY

The campaign ends, and nothing is known that was not known before it started.

### THE ASSUMPTION I TEST FIRST

Twenty sponsor conversations before the pre-seed gate, and the answer that kills it is written down in advance: if brands say they already know what they get, the analytics engine is not a differentiator.

Sponsor discovery programme, section 4.6: four buyer groups, seven questions, each one aimed at an assumption the model depends on.

THE MECHANISM

# One missing layer explains both halves

### IN A POPULAR SPORT

An agent introduces the athlete and vouches for the audience. Ten to twenty per cent, and the brand gets a number it can defend.

### IN A NICHE SPORT

There is no agent. The athlete's alternative is not a worse deal, it is no deal. The brand's alternative is a guess.

## AND THAT ABSENCE FEEDS ITSELF

**01** No route from audience to income

›

**02** So no reason to build an audience

›

**03** So the market measures smaller than it is

An agent introduces, and an agent vouches. Below the professional tier neither function exists: no route to income on one side, no basis for a decision on the other. So the market is sized under the incentives that suppress it, and the honest error direction is understatement.

THE PRODUCT

# Two engines, and each one is the other's reason to exist

ENGINE ONE

## Monetisation

ATHLETE AND FAN

The athlete's own page, with paid fan tiers they price themselves. They keep 85% and pay nothing to be there. Self serve, with no sales touch per subscriber.

**15% of fan revenue** · 48% of Y7

ENGINE TWO

## Analytics

SPONSOR

A campaign brief matched to athletes on measured audience evidence, every score decomposed into the arithmetic behind it, and delivery measured against what was projected.

**10% of deal value, plus €99 to €999 a month** · 52% of Y7

**THE ATHLETE PAYS NOTHING**

No monthly fee, ever, on either engine. The athlete earning €200 a month pays the same rate as the one earning €5,000, which a subscription would not have done. They are the supply, and supply is the constraint.

Stride financial model: Y7 net revenue of €3.01M, 48% from fans and 52% from the two sponsor streams.

WHY THEY ARE ONE COMPANY

# Each engine produces the input the other cannot buy

**01**

### Fans pay the athlete

Subscriptions give the athlete a reason to build an audience, and give us revenue from the first month.

›

**02**

### The athlete connects their platforms

Monetising requires the connectors. Those same connectors are the measurement instrument.

›

**03**

### The sponsor sees evidence

Measured reach, engagement and cost per thousand, per athlete, in place of a follower count.

›

**04**

### Deals raise athlete income

Which brings the next athlete, and arrives with an audience that can now be measured.

AND FOUR RETURNS TO ONE

**WHY NEITHER HALF STANDS ALONE**

A creator platform has no reason to measure an audience. A sponsorship data company has no relationship with the athlete, so it cannot get the measurements. Both halves are required, and that is the architecture rather than a roadmap.

Fan revenue funds the years in which the data accrues. By the time the analytics are worth selling, someone else has already paid to build them.

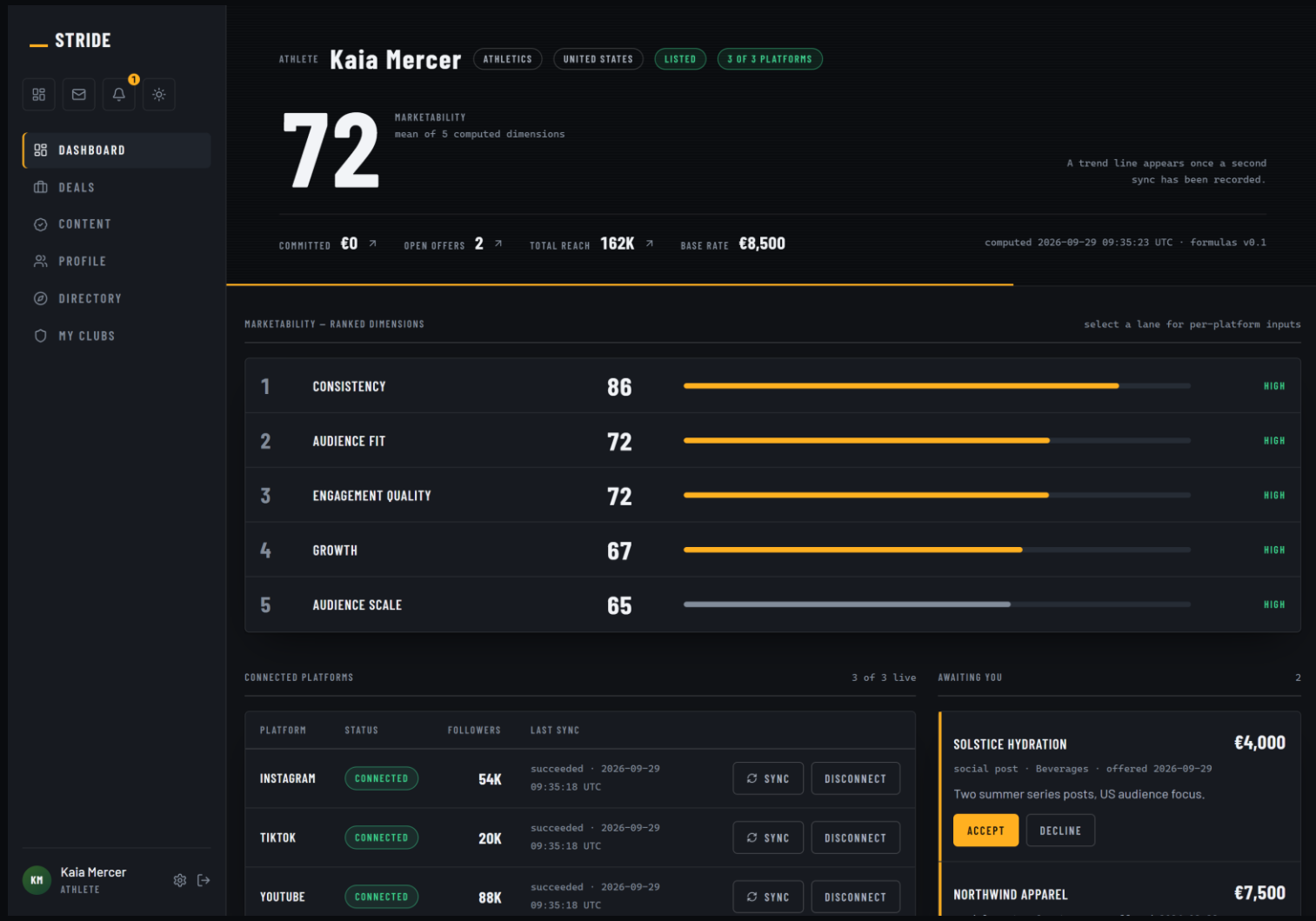
NOT A MOCKUP

# It is built, deployed, and you can open it now

- Admission gate with human review
- Versioned marketability scoring
- Explainable campaign matching
- Offers, deals, delivery measurement
- Audit log and a resilience drill
- Tests on two databases in CI

**stride-demo.onrender.com**

Fourteen demo accounts. Registration is open.



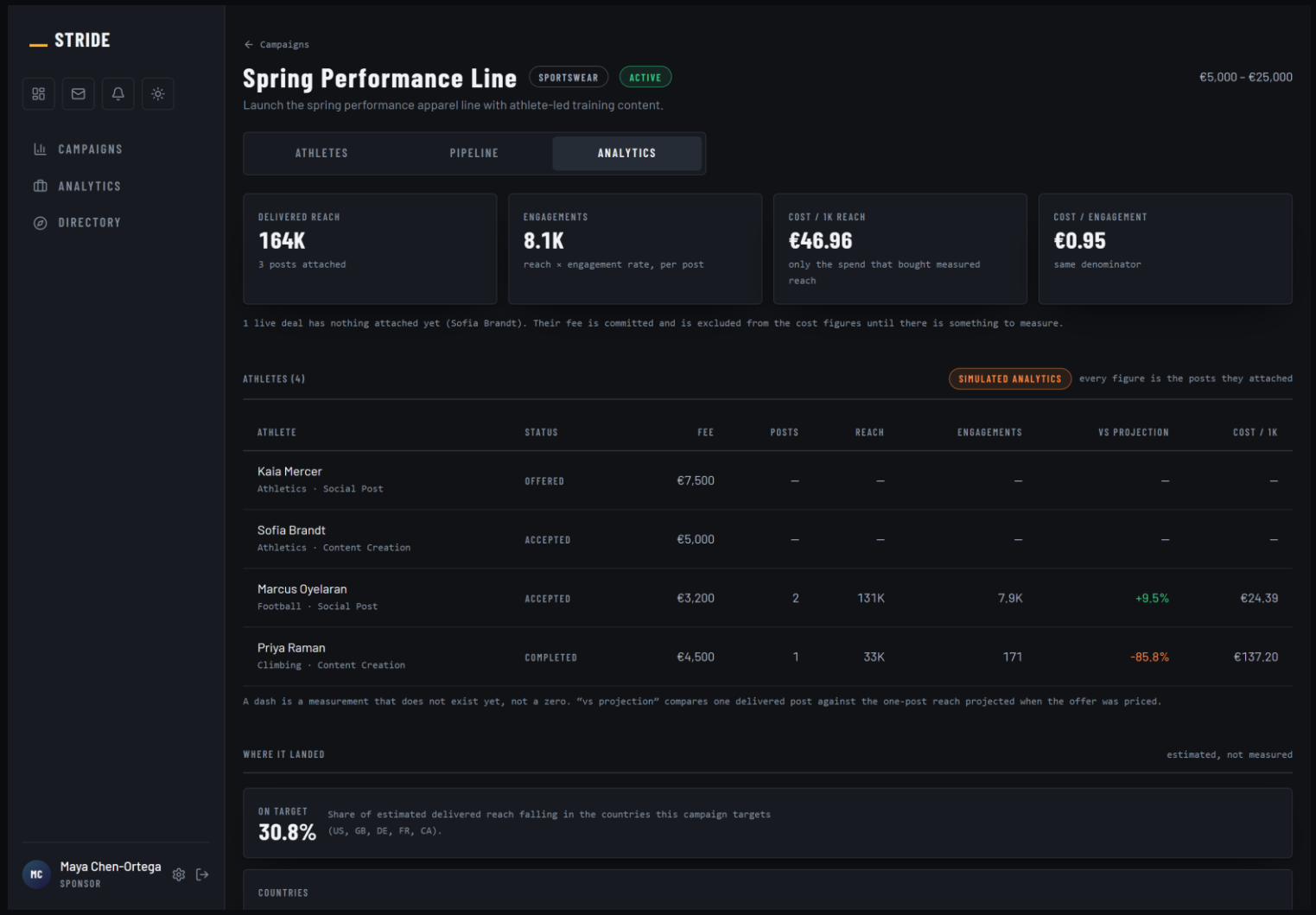

Athlete dashboard, captured from the running application.

THE SECOND ENGINE, RUNNING

# And this is what replaces the instinct

- Delivered reach and engagements, per athlete
- Cost per thousand reached, cost per engagement
- Delivered against what was projected when priced
- Share of reach landing in the targeted countries
- Every match score decomposed to its arithmetic
- A dash where nothing is measured. Never a zero

The arithmetic is shown because a brand that cannot audit the number will not spend against it a second time. The red figure on that screen is a deal that underdelivered, and the product says so.




Campaign result view, captured from the running application. The demo's engagement figures are seeded, and the product labels them simulated on the screen itself.

PRIMARY RESEARCH

# The research changed the product, which is the point of doing it

> Open registration to everyone, but build a filtering mechanism so that not anyone can register as an athlete.

Íñigo Cristóbal Losada, AI Lead at olympics.com, after eleven years at Olympic Broadcasting Services, where he was Broadcaster Services Manager through Tokyo 2020 and Beijing 2022.

## WHAT IT CHANGED

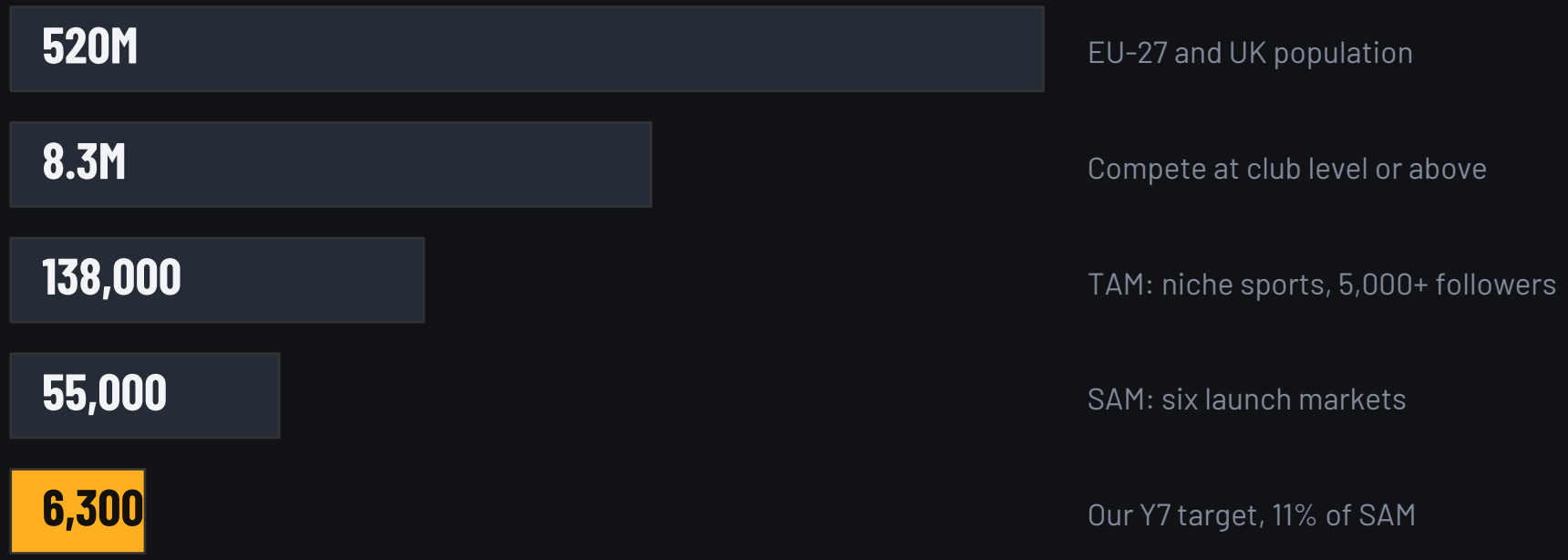
I had pitched it to him as a product for the IOC, open only to Olympic athletes. He rejected that framing outright.

The admission gate exists because of that conversation. It is not a feature that was designed and then justified.

It also settled market entry. An IOC-only product inherits the IOC's athletes: elite, represented, already monetised. The segment with the actual problem sits below that tier.

HOW BIG, BOTTOM UP

# A segment nobody measures is a segment nobody has sized a product for




EUROPEAN SPORT SPONSORSHIP

**€24.79bn**

Growing 5.9% a year

SPAIN, THE FASTEST MAJOR MARKET

**+14%**

Ahead of the UK and France

None of that top-down figure breaks below the professional tier. There is no published number for sponsorship of individual athletes, so the plan does not divide it by anything. The bottom-up funnel exists because the measured market stops exactly where ours starts.

European Sponsorship Association, 2025, via Statista. Funnel: Eurostat, Eurobarometer 525, and the plan's own Sport Opportunity Index.

THE WEDGE

# We start where there is no incumbent, because that is also where the economics are best

## NICHE SPORTS

**€16**

To acquire one athlete in Y1

**48%**

Of them monetise by Y7

## POPULAR SPORTS

**€40**

To acquire one athlete in Y1

**30%**

Of them monetise by Y7

Cheaper to acquire, and a larger share of them earn. A professional already has an agent and would not use this, so nobody is fighting us for a trail runner with 25,000 followers and an inbox of unanswered brand DMs. What we learn there generalises upward. Football does not generalise downward.

### WHY THE TWO SIDES FIT

A niche athlete's audience is concentrated where they train and compete. That concentration is worth little to a national advertiser, and it is exactly what the clinic two streets from the club is trying to buy and has no other way of buying. The same choice makes supply cheap and demand local.

Stride financial model, segment assumptions. Acquisition cost rises over the plan as the mix shifts toward popular sports.

FOUR COMPANIES TRIED THIS BEFORE US

# Two built the marketplace, two built the data. Nobody built both

| COMPANY | WHAT IT IS | AGE | PEOPLE | RAISED | WHERE IT GOT TO |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Sponsoo** | Marketplace, same model | 11 yrs | 13 | €2.17M | Total equity zero |
| **OpenSponsorship** | Marketplace, same model | 12 yrs | 23 | €7.6M | Still private |
| **Hookit** | Sponsorship data | 18 yrs | 47 | €21.5M | Sold |
| **SponsorUnited** | Sponsorship data, enterprise | 9 yrs | 355 | €38.8M | A different business |

The one that got large sells data to agencies and rights holders, and never executes a deal. 355 people is what enterprise sales costs, and it is the reason nobody runs this motion down at a €2,000 sponsorship.

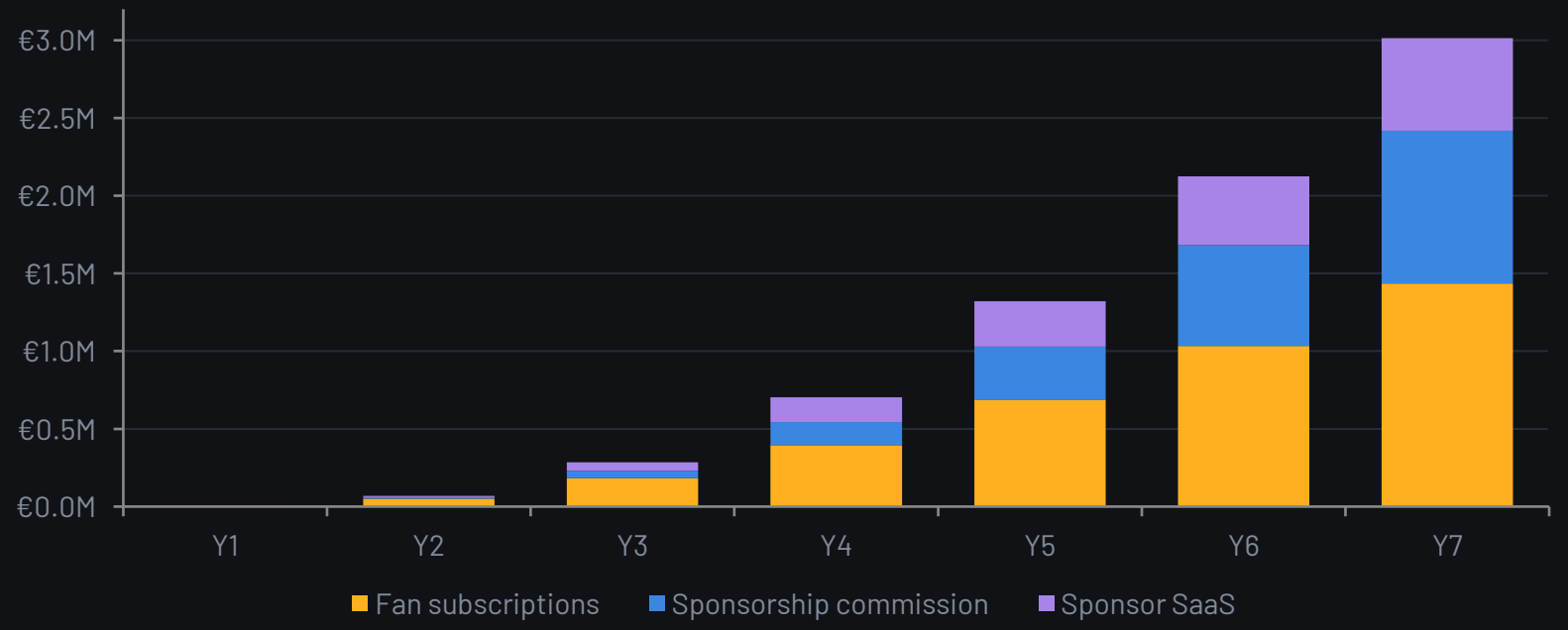
**THE SECOND PAYER**

Fan subscriptions are 48% of our Y7 revenue, and none of these four has that stream at all. If it works, the economics are not Sponsoo's. If it does not, they are, and this is Sponsoo with eleven fewer years of relationships. The plan prices both cases.

PitchBook company profiles, retrieved 1 October 2026, reported in euros.

REVENUE MODEL

# The business changes shape as it grows




Y2

**75%**

of revenue is fan subscriptions, the year the thesis is tested

Y7

**48%**

still fan, with sponsorship and SaaS compounding behind it

**€3.01M total at Y7**

Stride financial model. Y1 to Y7, net revenue after the athlete's share.

GO TO MARKET

# Year one, concretely

**250**

ATHLETES

recruited from 1,250 applications, in two or three niche Spanish sports

**20**

SPONSOR CONVERSATIONS

which are the first sales as much as the research, closing about 15 deals

**1**

SALARY

mine, plus a named athlete partner on 5% equity rather than cash

**€113k**

OF CASH

two thirds of it available as a non-dilutive ENISA loan

### THE SEQUENCE IS THE OPPOSITE OF THE OBVIOUS ONE

Build the payment rail and sponsorship billing first, and the fan tier last. Commission is invoiced against a signed deal: it needs no content moderation, no minors safeguarding and no media egress, so it is the cheapest of the three to build and the only one that earns inside the first year.

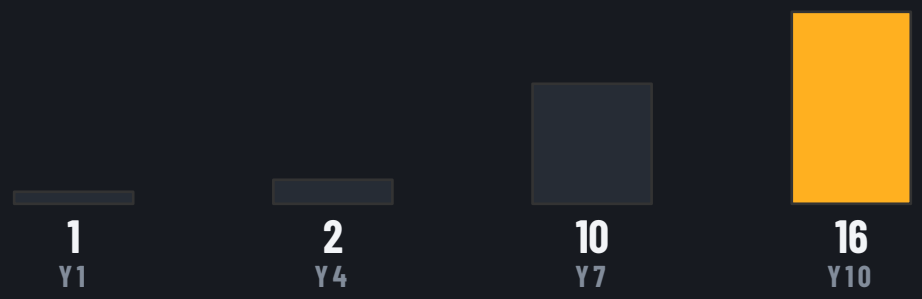
OPERATIONS AND PEOPLE

# One human step in the chain, and a team sized to what I can actually run

## WHAT IS SUBCONTRACTED

| | |
|---|---|
| **Stripe Connect** | Payments, KYC and payouts in 30+ countries |
| **AWS** | Compute, database and media processing |
| **Zero-egress CDN** | Media delivery, the cost that decides viability |

## HEADCOUNT



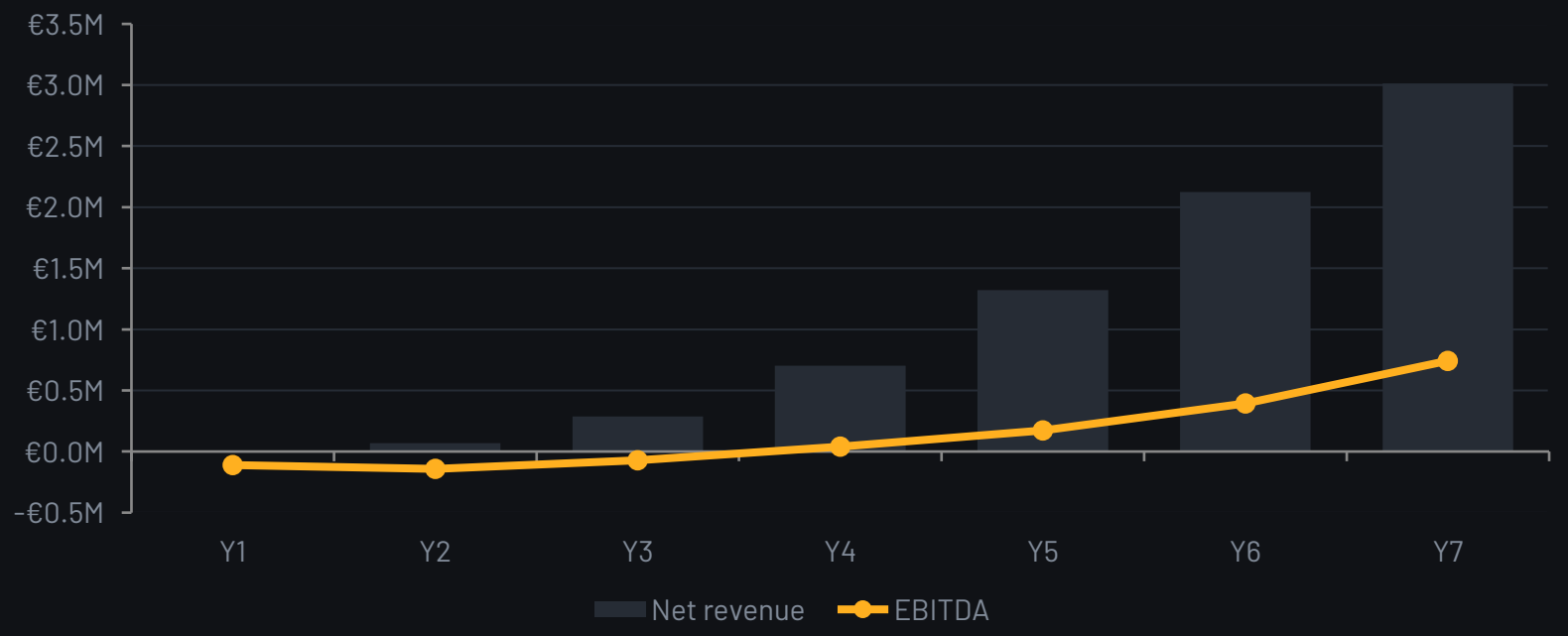

The only human step in the value chain is admission review, and it scales with applications rather than with transactions. That is why sixteen people can run this. Sponsoo took eleven years to reach thirteen, so the comparison is deliberate rather than optimistic.

**THE ASSUMPTION I AM MOST EXPOSED ON**

€301k of revenue per employee at Y7, against a private B2B SaaS median of €135k. If I am wrong, the first thing to give is headcount, which means slower growth rather than a cash crisis.

FINANCIAL PLAN

# Loss-making for four years, and the losses are small




EBITDA POSITIVE

**Y4**

CASH POSITIVE

**Y5**

Y7 EBITDA MARGIN

**24.7%**

Y10 NET REVENUE

**€5.25M**

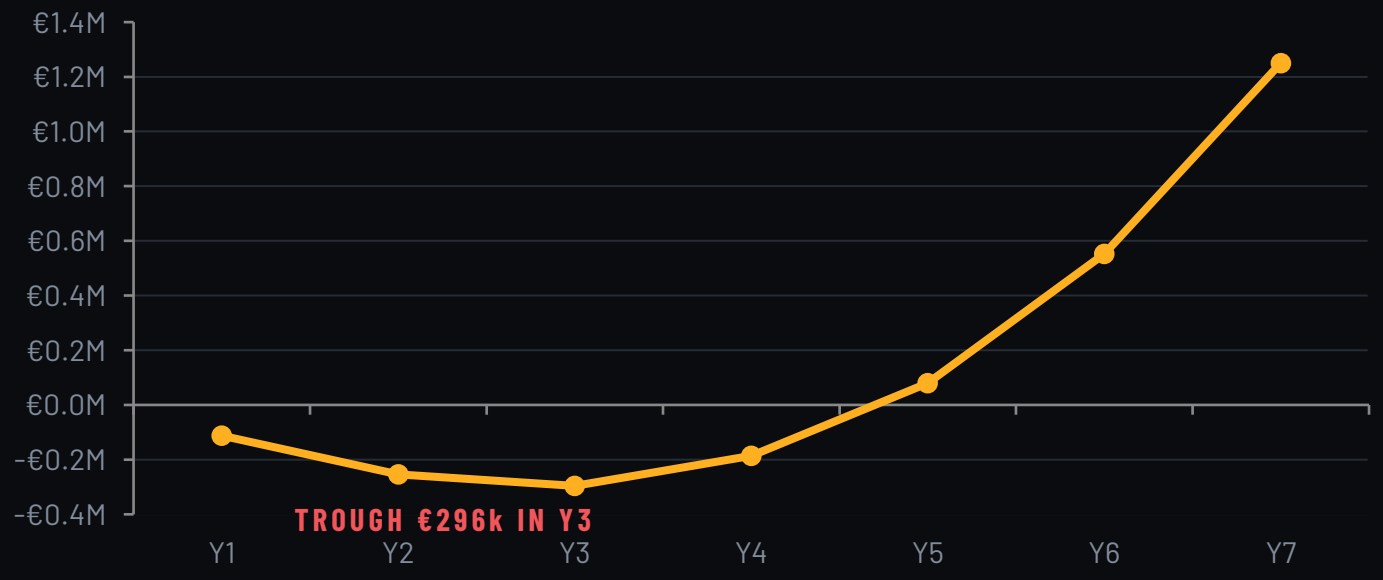
Gross margin climbs from 63% to 70%, not the SaaS 80%, because the payment rail is real.

Stride financial model, base case. Three scenarios are modelled; the pessimistic case still breaks even in Y5.

THE ASK

# €150k at €1.8M pre-money

The first of two tranches, and the round that clears the worst point in the cash curve




**TOTAL REQUIREMENT**
**€414k**
the €296k trough plus a 40% buffer

**NOW**
**€150k**
equity, which also unlocks €75k of non-dilutive ENISA debt

**IN Y2**
**€250k**
priced against three months of real subscription revenue, not a promise

Staging it costs about two points of equity and buys the right to price the second tranche on evidence. A plan whose survival does not depend on the next round arriving on schedule is a stronger one to raise against.

ONE ASSUMPTION CARRIES THIS PLAN

# Will fans of a semi-professional athlete actually pay?

No interview answers it and no amount of further market sizing can. Only three months of real subscription revenue from one anchor athlete settles it, and that is exactly what the pre-seed buys.

TESTED FOR

**€80k and one year**

rather than €2.6M and four

IF IT FAILS

**A smaller marketplace**

viable, but a different company

EVERYTHING ELSE

**Already done**

built, deployed and demonstrable

STRIDE

stride-demo.onrender.com

BACKUP

# Held for questions

The four steps, the matching arithmetic, how we differ from the data companies, pricing, scenarios, risk, valuation and the admission gate.

BACKUP, MECHANICS

# Four steps, and a rule that holds all four together

How an athlete gets in, gets scored, gets matched and gets paid.

## 01
### APPLY

The athlete connects their platforms and applies. Proof is checked automatically, then a person decides. A club can nominate a whole roster as a second route.

## 02
### SCORE

Marketability is computed on eight weighted components, each traceable to the posts behind it, and every score version is kept.

## 03
### MATCH

A sponsor briefs a campaign and receives a ranked shortlist in which every score decomposes: audience fit 72 × 32% = 23.1.

## 04
### DEAL

Offer, acceptance, delivery measured against what was projected. An unmeasured campaign reads as unmeasured, never as zero.

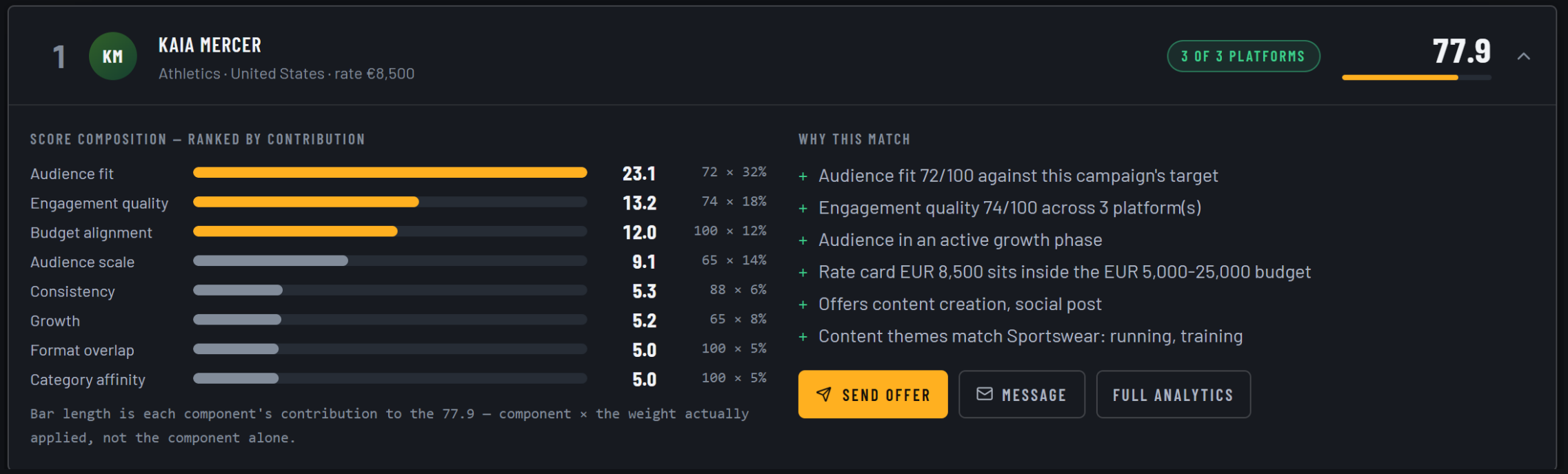
**NOTHING SELF-VERIFIES**

A club scoring above the verification bar still waits for a human. A rejected proof cannot be cleared by re-submitting the form. That is what a sponsor is actually buying.

BACKUP, THE MATCHING ENGINE

# A ranked athlete, opened on the arithmetic that ranked them

Eight weighted components. Bar length is the contribution to the total, not the component alone.




### THE WEIGHTS ARE HAND SET

A transparent weighted sum. Learned weights come once there are outcomes, and must beat this.

### COVERAGE TRAVELS WITH THE SCORE

Three of three platforms, or one of three. A thin score is marked thin, not quietly averaged.

### IT READS IN PLAIN LANGUAGE TOO

Because the person approving the spend is rarely the person running the campaign.

Ranked matches for a live campaign, captured from the running application.

BACKUP, THE COMPARABLE THAT GOT LARGE

# They sell what the market did. We measure what your money did

Slide 13 split the set two and two. This is what the split means to a brand with €2,000 to spend.

| | Sponsoo, OpenSponsorship<br>THE MARKETPLACES | Hookit, SponsorUnited<br>THE DATA COMPANIES | Stride<br>BOTH HALVES, ONE LOOP |
|---|---|---|---|
| CHOOSE | Browse a roster. Follower counts, self reported | Market intelligence: who sponsors whom, at scale | Ranked against your brief, every score decomposed |
| PRICE | You negotiate. No benchmark | A media value estimate for a property | A reach projection attached to the offer itself |
| VERIFY | Screenshots from the athlete | What the market did, from public posts | Delivered against that projection, per athlete |
| THE DATA | The athlete's own claim | Scraped, public, third party | The connector the athlete linked to get paid |
| THE BUYER | Brands of any size, thin support | Rights holders, agencies, enterprise seats | The clinic, the gym, the dealer |

**WHY THEY CANNOT FOLLOW**

Delivery is measured against a projection written onto the deal at the moment the offer is made. A company that was not in the transaction never saw the promise, so it has nothing to reconcile against. That is a position, not a feature.

Plan section 3.2.2 on the competitive set and section 4.6 on the buyer. Neither data company executes a deal.

BACKUP, PRICING

# 15% sits between the only two published rates in the market

Both ends of the corridor are real competitor economics, derived from filed accounts.

PATREON

**10%**

all-in, on filed accounts

STRIDE

**15%**

flat, and no monthly athlete fee

ONLYFANS

**20%**

and agencies take 20 to 50% on top

At 15% we undercut the nearest comparable for any athlete earning under €1,380 a month, which is the entire long tail we are built for. The decision forfeits €0.5M of Y7 revenue against a 20% take, and buys a pricing argument that survives contact with the exact athlete we target.

Patreon and OnlyFans published terms and filed accounts; agency rates from published commission guides.

BACKUP, SCENARIOS

# The plan survives its own pessimistic case

Each case re-runs the whole model on changed drivers rather than adjusting the base result.

| CASE | WHAT CHANGES | Y7 REVENUE | Y7 EBITDA | CAPITAL NEED | PROFIT FROM |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Pessimistic** | Fans/athlete –25%, monetise –20% | **€2.34M** | **€399k** | **€541k** | **Y5** |
| **Base** | As modelled | **€3.01M** | **€743k** | **€414k** | **Y4** |
| **Optimistic** | Fans/athlete +25%, monetise +20% | **€3.59M** | **€1.04M** | **€347k** | **Y4** |

Even the pessimistic case breaks even, one year later and on €541k instead of €414k. The downside here is a slower, smaller company rather than a failed one, and that is the property the staged raise is designed to protect.

Stride financial model, scenario table.

BACKUP, RISK

# Eleven risks scored, and one of them is the thesis

Probability × impact, both on a 1 to 5 scale. Nothing is rated more likely than 3.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| R1 | Fans do not pay for niche-athlete content | 3 × 5 = 15 | Three months of real revenue from one anchor athlete, before the second tranche |
| R4 | A funded entrant copies the model | 3 × 4 = 12 | The defence is scoring history and athlete relationships, which take time nobody can buy |
| R5 | Regulatory: DAC7, age assurance, startup law | 3 × 4 = 12 | Compliance built in rather than retrofitted; reporting is a product feature |

A risk map that is evenly scattered has not identified which risk is the real one. R1 is the thesis, and the entire financing structure exists to buy it down cheaply.

BACKUP, VALUATION

# Where the €1.8M pre-money comes from

Two methods that disagree, and the disagreement is the honest part.

### DCF ENTERPRISE VALUE

**€1.23M**

25% WACC, 3% terminal growth. Below the pre-money, which is normal for a pre-revenue venture.

### COMPARABLE SET

**€1.8M**

Benchmarked against Sponsoo and OpenSponsorship, the two companies running the same model.

### FOUNDER AND TEAM HOLD

**65.2%**

After both tranches, the optional growth round and a fully topped 10% ESOP.

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### PRE-SEED

€150k at €1.8M

**87.3%**

### EXTENSION

€250k at €3.5M

**81.5%**

### GROWTH, OPTIONAL

€1.5M at €12M

**72.4%**

### AFTER ESOP

10% pool

**65.2%**

Founder stake retained through each round

Stride financial model: DCF, comparable transactions from PitchBook, and the dilution waterfall.

BACKUP, THE GATE

# What the admission gate actually costs to run

The one human step in the chain, priced from the policy itself rather than assumed.

**30.5%**

ADMISSION RATE BY Y7

rising from 20% in Y1 as the funnel improves, which makes it a filter rather than a formality

**4 min**

MEDIAN MANUAL REVIEW

priced at the same loaded salary the people line uses

**0.64 FTE**

REVIEWER LOAD AT Y10

at 8,500 athletes. Verification is not a money problem at this scale

**< 48 h**

SERVICE LEVEL

the reason to automate is latency, not cost: a queued athlete is not earning

A club nomination brings a roster of 20 to 40 athletes with the verification problem already solved, and club-nominated applicants are admitted at 45% against 20% direct. That is the channel the growth plan opens at Y3.